

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Sixth-century BCE shramana field

AGRARIAN SURPLUS + CITIES + MAHAJANAPADAS + MERCHANTS + RITUAL QUESTIONING

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SHRAMANA FIELD

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JAINA

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BUDDHIST

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AJIVIKA

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other schools

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Heterodoxy is not one anti-Brahmana bloc; doctrines and disciplines differ.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Jain cosmos, bondage and liberation

JIVA (conscious) + AJIVA (non-conscious) -> beginningless cosmos without creator

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action/passions attract karmic matter -> bondage and repeated birth

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samvara stops influx + nirjara sheds karma -> kevala-jnana -> moksha

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Liberation is purification of an enduring individual soul, not annihilation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Jain path and many-sided knowledge

TRIRATNA: right faith + right knowledge + right conduct

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FIVE VOWS: ahimsa | satya | asteya | brahmacharya | aparigraha

monastic mahavrata = rigorous | lay anuvrata = limited practicable form

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ANEKANTAVADA -> NAYAVADA standpoints -> SYADVADA qualified predication

Many-sidedness disciplines claims; it does not make contradictions equally true.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Jain community, canon and spread

Parshvanatha -> Mahavira -> fourfold sangha -> councils/redactions -> sects
23rd Tirthankara 24th monks/nuns/lay Pataliputra/Valabhi Digambara/Shvetambara
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patronage and merchants -> Mathura, western India, Karnataka -> temples/literature
Sect differences include clothing, canon and liberation questions.
Avoid reducing separation to one famine story or treating all traditions as identical.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Buddhist diagnosis and disciplined path

DUKKHA -> SAMUDAYA (craving/ignorance) -> NIRODHA -> EIGHTFOLD PATH



MIDDLE WAY rejects indulgence and self-mortification; nirvana ends causes of dukkha.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Dependent origination and no-self

ignorance -> formations -> consciousness -> name-form -> six senses -> contact
-> feeling -> craving -> clinging -> becoming -> birth -> ageing-and-death

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conditioned arising explains continuity without eternal atman or first creator.

aggregates: form, feeling, perception, formations, consciousness -> impermanent/anatta

karma preserves ethical causation through process; nirvana is not physical death.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Buddhist sangha, councils and canons

BUDDHA/DHAMMA -> monastic SANGHA under VINAYA <-> lay gifts, merit and protection

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conventional councils: Rajagriha -> Vaishali -> Pataliputra -> regional recensions

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Pali Tipitaka: Vinaya + Sutta + Abhidhamma; other witnesses survive in Sanskrit, Chinese and Tibetan traditions. Councils are sectarian memories, not court minutes. Women ordain, but institutional hierarchy and textual debate remain.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Buddhist developments: schools to Vajrayana

EARLY SCHOOLS -> MAHAYANA -> MADHYAMAKA/YOGACARA -> VAJRAYANA

Vinaya/Abhidharma	bodhisattva ideal	emptiness/mind debates	mantra/mandala/tantra
multiple nikayas	new sutras	philosophy systems	ritual monasteries

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Theravada is one surviving early tradition; Hinayana is a polemical label, not synonym.

Maitreya/paramitas fit Mahayana; Vajrayana is a later development.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Networks, material culture and outcomes

GANGA HEARTLAND -> stupas/monasteries -> trade routes and political patronage

Mauryan/post-Mauryan support -> Sanchi, Bharhut and caves -> donors/artisans

NORTH-WEST/CENTRAL ASIA -> Silk routes -> China -> Korea/Japan

SRI LANKA -> Theravada transmission -> Southeast Asian histories

JAIN NETWORKS -> Mathura/western India/Deccan/Karnataka -> temples/manuscripts

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Buddhism later declined/absorbed in India as patronage and monastery networks changed;
Jainism persisted through lay institutions, regional patrons and adaptive communities.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Jainism-Buddhism comparison and answer spine

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the shramana setting and identify each source tradition.
 2. Connect doctrine -> institution -> social base -> patronage -> spread.
 3. Compare Jain jiva and restraint with Buddhist anatta and Middle Path.
- VERDICT: Shared context produced distinct paths, institutions and trajectories.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Canonical texts preserve layered doctrine, discipline and sect memory.
2. Inscriptions identify donors and institutions, not total populations.
3. Archaeology maps practice and networks but cannot read belief directly.

VERDICT: Triangulate text, inscription and material context at matching scales.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Traditional dates and council narratives require school-specific labels.
2. Jain jiva is not Buddhist anatta; Theravada is not a synonym for Hinayana.
3. Ashoka aided Buddhism but did not create or single-handedly spread it.

VERDICT: Reject single-cause rise, one-event sect splits and total disappearance.